Overview of Serco Business Lifecycle and Bidding Methodology

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Introduction

Why do we bid and what is it?

The Business Lifecycle – Our Bid Policy

Bid Governance and Decision Gates 1-5

Bidding Services Bid Methodology Overview

- Focus on Proposal Submission
- Role of Solution Hats and Red Team Reviews

Wrap-up and Closing Remarks

Learning Objectives

1. Gain understanding of Serco's Business Lifecycle, Bid Policy and how the bidding cycle aligns to SMS Bidding Standard
2. Gain understanding of the role of BLRT, Bidding Governance Gates 1-5 and the associated key mandatory activities and compliance requirements
3. Raise awareness of the bid methodology process, esp. Proposal Development and Submission
4. Understand the role solution hats play in developing a compelling proposition
5. Understand the role and purpose of the red team review in articulating our offer and maximising evaluation score

Why do we bid?

For business growth:

- Growth funds development
  - Provides war-chest for improving services via tech or process re-design
  - Provides reserves to respond to changes in the market
- Growth can mitigate risk
  - Provides new customers to replace inevitable customer attrition – competition/ change of decision makers/ bankruptcy
  - Diversification – new market entry/proposal
- Spread cost of overheads over greater customer base
  - In highly competitive markets, ratio of overhead to margin is significant in determining success

Bidding for work is the lifeblood of Serco. Whether we are tendering for new contracts, growing our business, or retendering, Serco relies on a healthy sales and bidding function to ensure future prosperity, development and growth

What is Bidding?

- All public sector contract tenders and notices are published as OJEU notices.
- There are a number of different procurement routes that can be used:
  - Open procedure
  - Restricted procedure
  - Competitive negotiated procedure
  - Competitive dialogue
  - Innovation partnership
  - Design contest
- Procurement frameworks – Crown Commercial Services, Gcloud (10 iterations) (IT), FATS 5 (Defence) Dynamic Purchasing frameworks (prison education)
- Procurement trends

A staged approach

Qualification

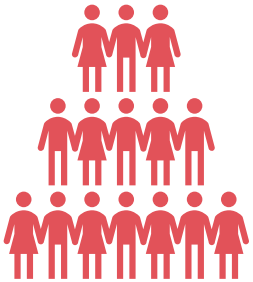
- Supplier Questionnaires
- Pre-Qualification Questionnaires
- Frameworks
- Dynamic Purchasing

Tender

- Invitation to:
  - Tender
  - Negotiate
  - Submit final tender
- Competitive Dialogue
- Best and Final Offer

Award

- Preferred Bidder
- Contract Award
- Alcatel – 10 day
- Authority Due Diligence



Service

- Mobilisation
- Transition
- Go Live
- BAU
- Transformation
- Continuous Improvement

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Our Bid Policy

- We need clarity, transparency and **commercial rigour** in our business processes to compete successfully for those contracts that **add most value** for our customers and investors. We will ensure that our proposals focus on the **customer's known needs**; and combine operational realism with innovation.
- We will achieve this by applying a **formal governance process** and standardised programme management framework, aimed at **delighting our customers** from bid through transition.

SMS Bid Standard

The SMS Bidding Standard is applicable to all New Bids, Contract Extensions and Rebids. All bids are subject to the governance defined in the SMS Standard and the levels of sign-off defined in the Delegated Authorities GSOP.

https://my.serco.com/cms/wp-content/uploads/2019/04/SMS-GS-BD1_Bidding.pdf

The Bidding Lifecycle

What is it?

- Serco's approach to the creation and governance of bids/proposals in response to client requirements

Features

- Aligned to HM Government procurement processes and applicable legislation and regulations
- Provides efficient planning and control mechanisms for bidders and Serco management
  - Alignment to Serco Management System (SMS) policy and standards
  - Compliance with Serco governance and management operating procedures
- Enables a consistent method of approach to all sales opportunities

Benefits

- Consistent process to produce quality proposals
- Improve win rates
- Optimisation of opportunity choices
- Enhanced customer perception of Serco proposal

Introducing Serco Business Lifecycle

Stage	Sales & Bidding						Transition & Transformation		Operations	
Business Focus	**Business Development and Marketing** Engagement with customer Develop value propositions	**Sales and Bidding** Customer procures goods/services which meet requirements, deliver value for money, customer satisfaction and enhance financial standing and/or public reputation					**Contract Start** Contractual agreement and transfer of accountability for service delivery	**Transition** Efficient service start up	**Operational Service Delivery** BAU service delivery, performance and quality assurance, end-user satisfaction and value for money and continuous service improvement	**Extension, Re-Bid and Exit:** Customer engagement for extension or successful transition and close down
Lifecycle Phase	Pre Qualify	Go Get	Short List	Confirm Bid	Bid Sign Off	Contract Sign off	Contract Start	Transition Close	Service Delivery	Extension, Re-Bid and Exit
Gate Decision Points	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9

Operational Business Policies & Standards, Business Controls and Assurance

- Bidding
- Transition
- Transition
- People
- Services
- Information
- Business

serco

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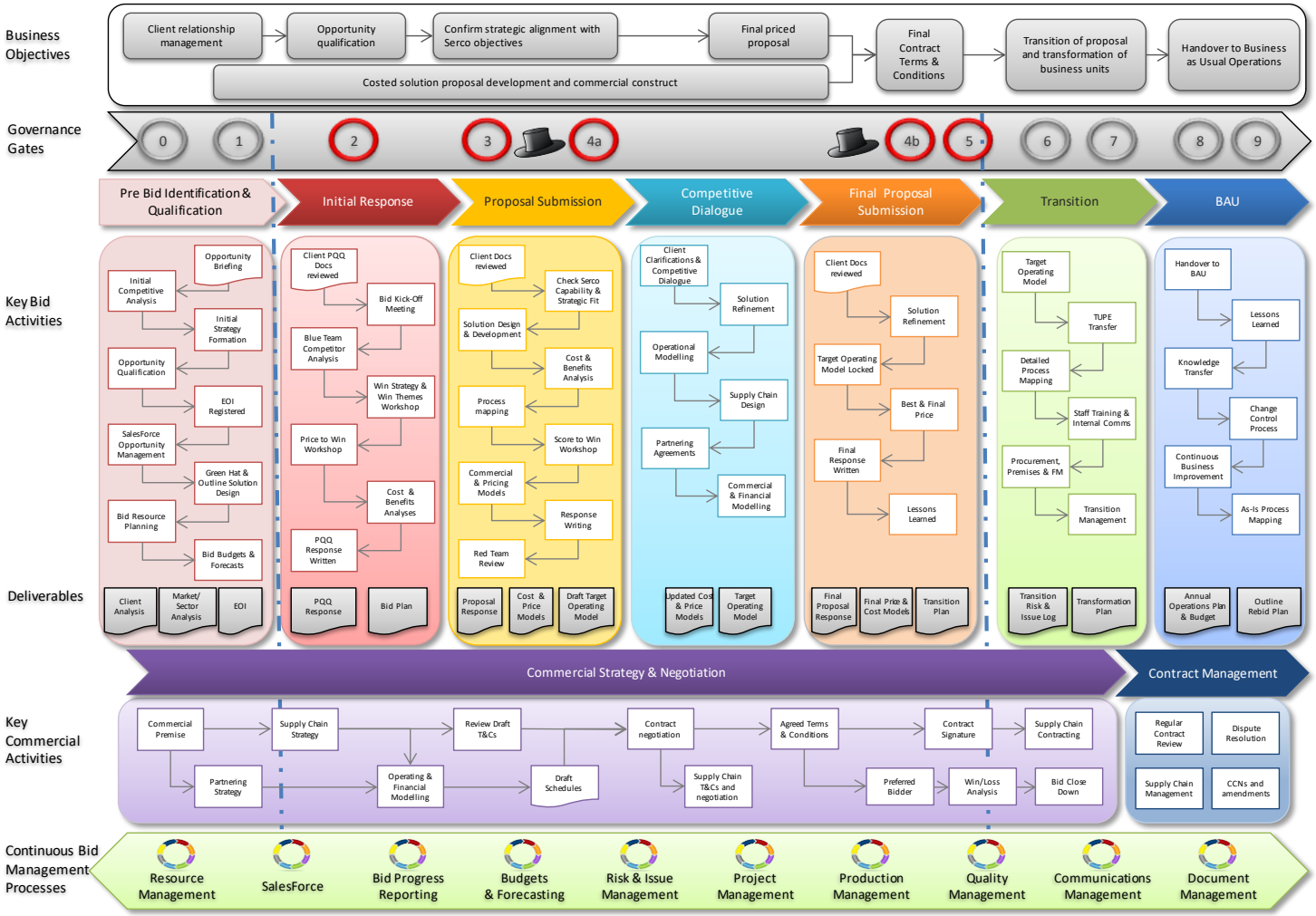
Bid Management underpinned by robust bid methodology



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SMS Bidding Standard Requirements Governance & Roles

- **No delegation** of authority allowed (Use of DAM)
- **Clearly delineated roles**, responsibility on BU MDs to ensure solutions are deliverable
- Documented **authority from Group CEO** required for changes to process
- Business Lifecycle governance responsibility of **Divisional Business Lifecycle Review Teams (BLRT)**
- **Independence and rigour** required between bid, BLRT and Black Hat teams
- BLRT **accountable** for all governance activities, overseeing progress of bid from start to finish and authorising progress through gates
- BLRT **accountable** for margin and deliverability of bids and not expose Group to inappropriate level of risk
- **Mandatory** documented sign-off of Qualification and Gate checklists at all gates

Serco Management System Qualification Criteria – All Gates

A **NO BID DECISION** will be taken if any of the Qualification Criteria below exists

- The bid is not **aligned** to core markets, geography or services, unless specifically authorised by the Investment Committee
- The Division/Business Unit cannot evidence strong and resilient **customer relationships**, evidenced, as a minimum, by regular formal and informal meetings
- Appropriate **shaping** of the opportunity has not been undertaken
- A bid **budget** has not been approved or the identified Bid Team cannot be deployed
- A **partnering** assessment has not been carried out and if a requirement for partners is identified a partnering strategy cannot be clearly articulated and **contractual terms defined**
- The bid does not meet defined **return on investment**, cash, revenue and profit requirements
- The **risk** profile of the bid or contract is outside appropriate Divisional or Group risk tolerances and the relevant risks cannot be removed or mitigated to bring them within those tolerances
- The bid has been presented to the Investment Committee and it has **been rejected**
- There are **ethical** concerns, material health & safety issues or other known material issues (such as lessons from previous similar bids) that in the reasonable view of the BLRT would compromise our ability to proceed further

Gate Breakdown

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Gate 0/1 – Opportunity Approved/Go Get

Timing

- *Market intelligence, Prior information notice, Industry supplier briefing (Gate 0)*
- *OJEU Notice (Gate* 1)

Prerequisite

- Market knowledge / intelligence of opportunity and / or solution

Outcome of BLRT

- Decision made to pursue opportunity (Gate 0)
- Agreement to invest resource into opportunity (Gate 1)

Pre-Gate Mandatory activities

- Identify high level risks
- Calculate bid budget for pre-qualification (ready reckoner-level)
- Confirm scope within business strategy
- If opportunity meets Investment Committee criteria, refer to Investment Committee (ICM) guidance
- Confirmation that discussions have been held with the customer and the customer has confirmed that they are likely to procure
- Enter opportunity information on Dynamics (CRM)
- Update Dynamics (CRM) with qualification and bid budget
- Complete Dynamics (CRM) governance

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Gate 2 – Approve Pre-Qual/EOI

2
Gate 2
Short-listing

Timing

- Before PQQ/EOI (or similar) submission date

Prerequisite

- Opportunity is real and valid as confirmed at Gate 1

Outcome of BLRT

- Approval to submit
- Approval to continue in line with budget to Gate 3
- Confirmation of Black Hat challengers
- Sign off sheet completed

We believe we can win – we understand the customer, have the capability to bid, our solution is based on existing competencies, and we can deliver the services

Pre-Gate Mandatory Activities

- Due diligence on the opportunity undertaken
- Competitor analysis developed
- Bid Team resource requirements defined
- Interdivisional trading agreements and specific resources identified
- Make or buy analysis undertaken by bid team and due diligence on potential partners is completed
- Revalidate bid budget for approval (mid-level detail)
- An outline solution (technical and financial) has been defined and high level costings established and a formal review has been undertaken
- Complete Dynamics (CRM) governance

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Gate 3 – Confirm Bid and Proposal Development

3
Gate 3
Confirm Bid

Timing

- As soon after issue of ITT or similar as possible (allowing for analysis)

Prerequisite

- Gate 2 held and mandatory governance complete
- If Gate 2 not required (e.g. no pre-qual required), Gates 2 and 3 to be combined

Outcome of BLRT

- Approval to continue in line with budget
- Sign off sheet completed

We want to win, believe we can win, and have a differentiated proposition

Pre Gate Mandatory Activities

- Kick-off meeting has been held
- Identify resources (within Bid Team / wider Serco / external)
- Confirmation that the outline solution and costings remain valid and plan is in place to refine them in line with customer requirements
- *MTT plan (including an assessment of resources) has been produced.*
- Non-disclosure Agreements in place with external partners or suppliers
- *Teaming Agreement in place and commercial terms finalised (inter Divisional and external partners/suppliers*)
- Refine and produce detailed bid budget
- Principal risks are detailed and addressed in line with Risk Management Framework
- Complete Dynamics (CRM) governance

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Gate 4 – Bid Sign Off and Proposal Submission

4
Gate 4
Bid Sign-off

Timing

- In advance of tender submission or similar (offer capable of acceptance or material stage in customer view)

Prerequisite

- Gate 3 held and mandatory governance complete
- Technical/Operational as well as Financial/Legal/Commercial Black Hats held and actions completed

Outcome of BLRT

- Full submission sign off (caveated as the case may be)
- Approval to submit tender
- Sign off sheet completed

We want to win, believe we can win, and have a differentiated proposition

Pre-Gate Mandatory Activities

- Solution and Financial model design and confirmation
- Detailed solution and costings finalised and approved by sign off by relevant authority
- Commercial sign off
- Response to all ITT questions written (in final draft format)
- Full bid cost against budget calculated
- Red Team review
- Mobilisation, Transition (and Transformation) Plan complete
- *Opportunities Register*
- Risk and Mitigations register fully up-to-date on e-STRIM
- Agreements in place with all subcontractors
- *Quality Management plan*
- Complete Dynamics (CRM) governance

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Gate 5 – Contract Sign-Off and Start Up

5
Gate 5
Contract
start up

Timing

- Contract signature imminent

Prerequisite

- Preferred Bidder status has been awarded and final negotiations with customer have taken place

Outcome of BLRT

- Approval to sign contract
- Sign off sheet completed

Pre-Gate Mandatory activities

- Changes to solution made and confirmed
- Final price confirmed
- Any material changes to the contract terms and conditions or timelines are presented to Gate
- *Customer sign-off on transition plan*
- Update stakeholder engagement plan

Pre-Gate Mandatory Activities (Cont)

- Confirm Contract Commencement date and Service Start date
- Transition Director and team identified and in post and budget is available to transition the opportunity
- Confirmation that sub-contractors are ready to proceed (conditions precedent)
- Confirm Gate 6 Contract Board start-up date and membership
- Risk Register updated and ready for handover
- Update Quality Management, Health Safety & Compliance, and Information Management Plans
- Confirm audit schedule
- Arrangements to sign contract in place (in accordance with delegations and customer requirements

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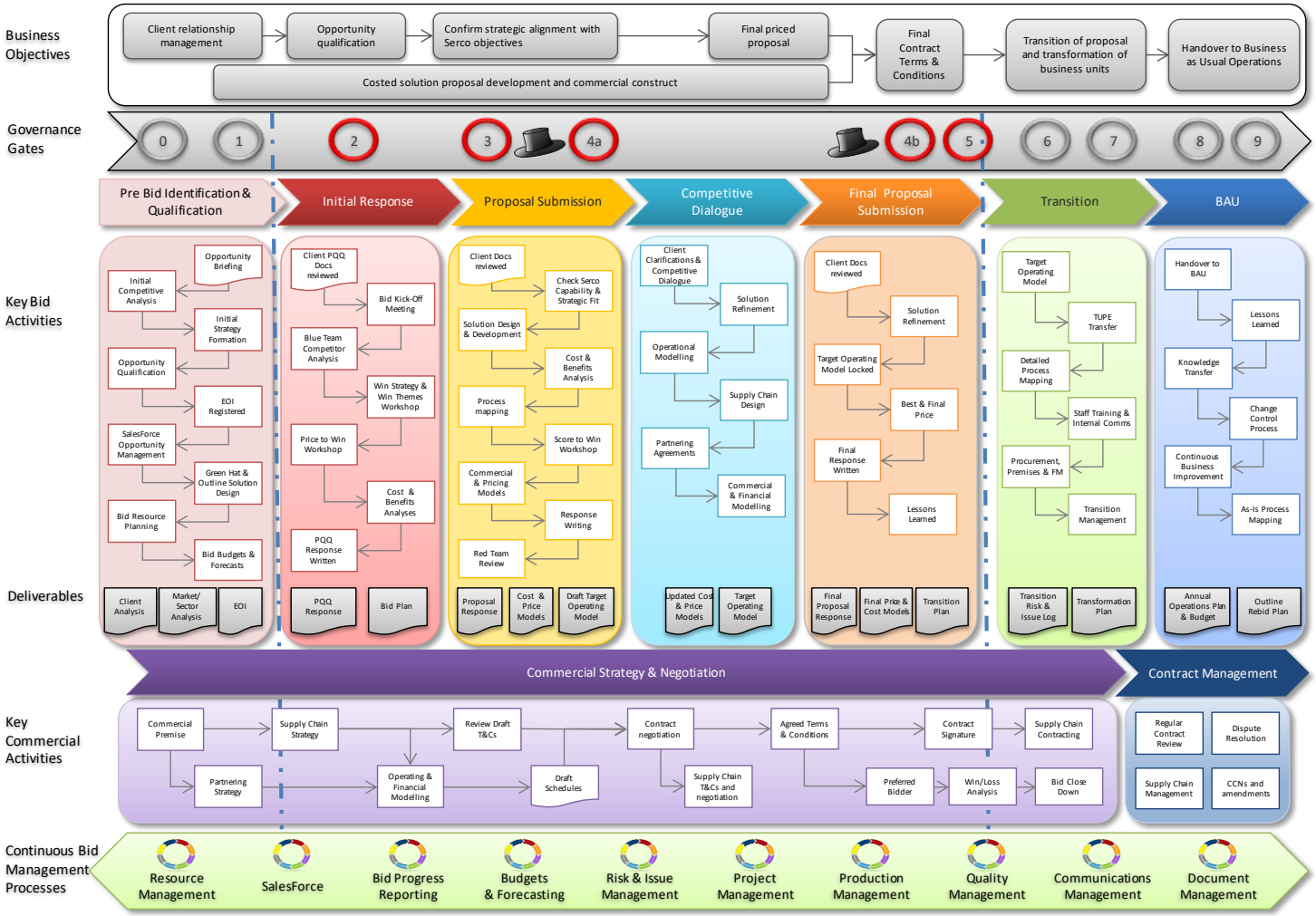
Bid Management underpinned by robust bid methodology



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Remember!

- The method diagram shows all of the common bid activities in one place.
- It is a reference tool… **one size does not fit all!**
- Individual bids will have differing requirements, first and foremost we must
  - Be led by the client's procurement process
  - Plan our bid around the client's published requirements
  - Agree our bid deliverables and timetables

- Never be afraid to ask questions of bid teams…someone, somewhere has done one like this before!

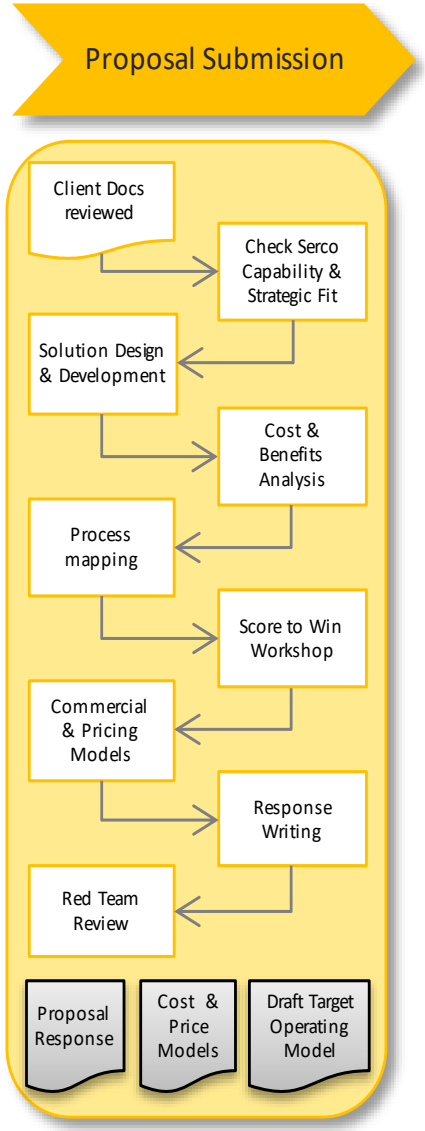
Who are the Bid Team

Who gets involved with bidding and what are some of the core roles within the team

Core Roles
Capture Lead/Bid Director
Senior Bid Manager / Bid Manager
Solution Architects / Operational Subject Matter Experts
Commercial Manager / Analyst
Legal Business Partner
Mobilisation & Transition Lead
HR Lead
Bid Writer
Bid Coordinator

Business Areas		
Operations – SMEs	Commercial	Legal
Mobilisation and Transition	Health, Safety & Environment	Ethics & Compliance
Tax	Treasury	HR
Risk	Security	IT
Insurance	Finance	Procurement
Pensions	Transformation	Centre of Excellence

Proposal Submission of Bid Methodology - Gate 3 & 4



- Why is this crucial?
  - The Proposal Submission is the main stage of the tendering process and is normally a formal response to a customer tender
- Why do you need to know this?
  - Ensure that you can plan for and develop a winning proposal that is of exceptional quality, and contains appropriate risk. You should understand the processes and principles of:
    - Solution design
    - Cost analysis
    - Contract review
    - Black hatting
    - Bid writing
    - Governance

Client Docs Reviewed

- Bid Manager to check all files, attachments and annexes in the contents list have been received.
- Bid Manager to check any ITT documentation is stored correctly if there is any protectively marked.
- Whole Bid team to read the entire documentation, and focus on their assigned areas.
- Data Room – Also check all documents have been received and all annexes or reference docs are present
- Analyse cover to cover! Then read it again....and again.
- Capture CQs as you review the documents. Analyse Competitor CQs.
- All identified CQs collated by Bid Manager and reviewed by Capture Lead and Commercial before submitting to Customer.
- Note timescales – particularly if they are amended during the process.

Check Serco capability and strategic fit

Forming relationships with suppliers and partners

- Re-test whether partnerships and relationships are correct (teaming agreements, workshare, ExLab, etc). Agreement through Gate 3 (and EAB or Partnering Boards if appropriate).
- Check with the BD team that Serco's capability can meet the requirement, and aligns with Divisional strategy.
- Examination of Serco's core capabilities and capacity allow the review of the opportunity, and a recommendation of BID/NO BID to the Gate 3.
- If at any time there is doubt about our ability to either win, or successfully deliver a profitable business, a thorough investigation must be undertaken and a BLRT/Board convened to discuss and agree any actions.

Serco capabilities & strategic fit

- Client requirements are known and understood.
- Serco's capabilities and capacity to deliver is understood.
- Strategic fit is challenged and agreed.
- Liaise with other Serco capabilities, e.g. Experience Lab, Citizen Services etc.
- Shared Services and integrated service offerings should be considered.

Solution Design and Development/Configuration

- Suppliers shortlisted by the customer after PQQ stage are invited to submit their proposals for operation of the contract being offered. Bids will often be evaluated by the customer in terms of quality, cost and benefit to the tendering organisation and/or the end user of the service.
- The aim of solution design is to provide the most compelling, compliant and competitive proposal.
- Adoption of solution design methods and controls, incl. SPIN, VPSD, EOM to get to the Target Operating Model (TOM)
- Tension between: Standardised, Configured, Innovative and in what ratio.

Solution Design Process

- Analysis of the existing solution
- Analysis of partnering requirements
- Analysis of what will win
- Operational input
- Innovation input

- Cost and Price Methodology (Lowest Price Technically Acceptable LPTA)
- Sensitivity Analysis
- Continuous Improvement and Operational Excellence
- **ABOVE ALL - ANSWER THE EXAM QUESTION!!**

Cost & Benefit Analysis

Cost Analysis and Process Mapping

- To develop winning solutions with sustainable profitability it is necessary to understand the cost of running the business.
- The Solution Lead and Solution Team are responsible for exploring and defining all areas of the TOM and identifying associated costs.
- The Commercial Lead ensures cost modelling resource is available to the bid team to assist with the capture and analysis of costs
- Where the opportunity is a re-bid, existing process mapping of the 'As-Is' business will significantly assist the process, along with cost models and budget information which will need to be obtained from the current operation.

Typical Outputs

- Cost & Pricing Modelling – including Y1/Y2... operating P&L
- Cost benefits analysis
- Benefits realisation planning
- Commercial models – incl. legal entities, partnering, supply chain, contract governance
- Agreements and contract structures
- Service Credit/Debit
- Payment mechanisms – including KPIs
- Warrantees and guarantees
- ROI – Bid costs
- Risks, assumptions & dependency logs
- Exit management model

Score to Win

Score to Win Workshop

- Scoring to Win enables the bid team to ensure that our submitted response to the client achieves the highest possible evaluation scores. Score to Win is reliant upon the availability of customers evaluation criteria.
- Score to Win should be used in all bids. If you don't have evaluation criteria you should consider whether or not to bid.
- Many customers will use their evaluation criteria to support a Most Economically Advantageous Tender (MEAT) evaluation.

Typical TOP TIPS:

- Price doesn't always win. Keep your eye on the technical score.
- Consider compliance as your baseline for Technical marks.
- Often only price versus quality is considered but also reflect on contract (mark-up) evaluation and risk transfer.
- Pay particular attention to PASS/FAIL criteria.
- Look out for weighted price:quality scoring ratios
- Consider a 'No Bid' recommendation if the evaluation criteria are not fully disclosed.

https://assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/government/uploads/system/uploads/attachment_data/file/891150/Bid_Evaluation_-_Guidance_Note_-_June_2020.pdf

Commercial & Pricing Models

Financial modelling & partial review of Contract T&Cs

- Plan, Plan, Plan.....and Plan again.
- Full and close integration of Commercial Lead into Bid Team.
- Commercial Lead is responsible for financial modelling, testing, sensitivity analysis and volume pricing scenarios.
- Legal complete the contract review, working closely with commercial.

Key inputs:

- Win Strategy and Score to Win.
- Detailed Cost Analysis & Draft Target Operating Model.
- Supply Chain & partnering options.
- Commercial Risk Analysis informing Risk Register.

Fundamentals:

- Involve Commercial early.
- Secure appropriate resource.
- Review and comment/mark-up of the draft T&Cs required during the proposal submission stage.
- Allow time to complete and review pricing models, incl. by third parties as necessary.

Standard Models

- The Commercial Team has a suite of standard models that can be used on certain bids. Further information and guidance on Financial and Commercial modelling can be sought from the Commercial Team.

Bid Writing

Story Boards

- Effective storyboards are invaluable in the preparation of the bid.
- Provide a compliant and compelling proposal.
- Aid proposal planning, document development and reviews.
- Help ensure solution integrity and identify dependencies.
- Describe:
  - win themes and key messaging
  - strategy
  - differentiators
  - dependencies
  - key solution.

TOP TIPS:

- Make sure you answer every question and every element thereof
- Ensure all key messages, diagrams are included in the storyboard
- Ensure the storyboard is independently reviewed.
- Watch out for Method Statement requests, this is a Contractual Response, not a sales response.
- Will the response form a schedule to the contract? Language and commitments!
- Post PQQ, be ruthless with non-value add sales and promotional material.

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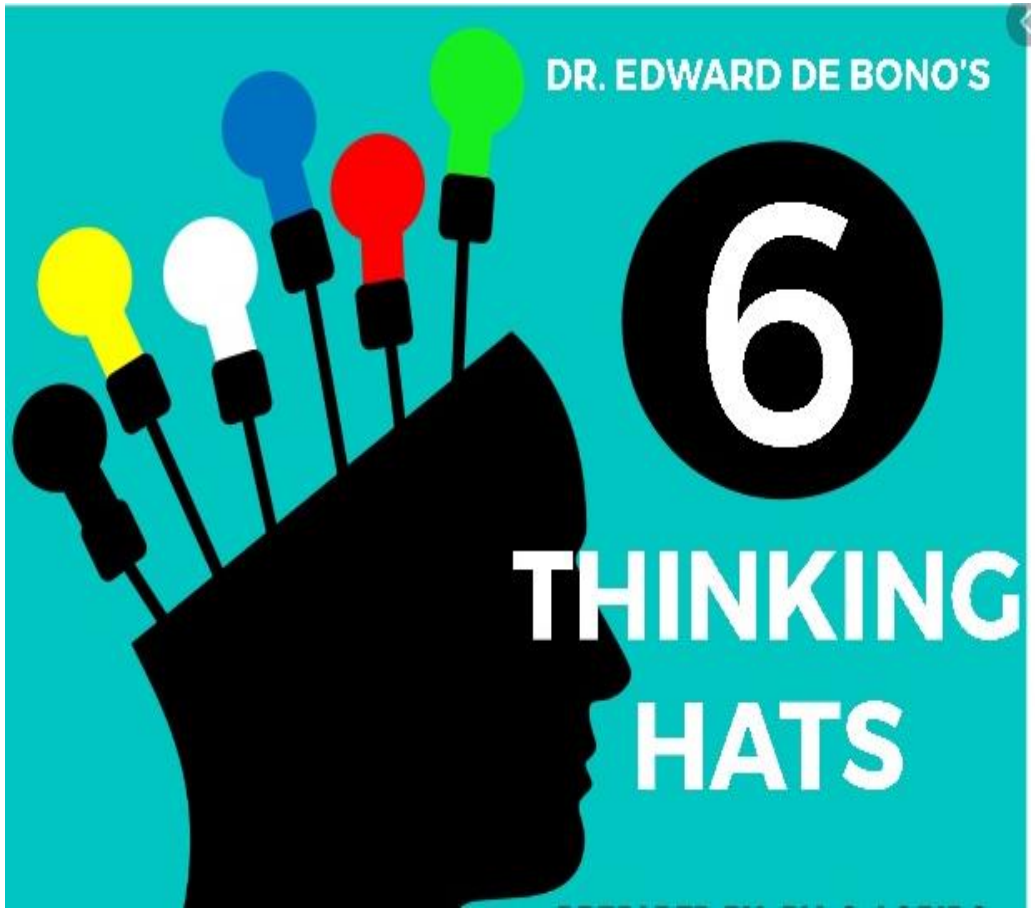
Developing the bid - Role of solution hats

Based on tried and tested Six Thinking Hats techniques developed by Dr Edward de Bono world leading authority in creativity and conceptual thinking.



Dr. Edward De Bono

Edward De Bono is a world-known expert in creative thinking. The 6 Thinking Hats is one such technique.

The main idea is to have the group only "wear one hat at a time" when considering a problem. The wearing of the hat is metaphorical. At any one time, everyone will wear the same colour, in other words, look at the problem at hand from only one perspective, the perspective indicated by the hat colour.

Green Hats – Ideas and Creativity

The Green Hat

What are some possible ways to work this out?

New, different ideas or approach

What are some 'out of the box' ideas that this could create

Alternatives and enhancing

Ways to solve problems

Innovation

- Conducted as early as possible in the bid, pre-bid if possible but as a minimum ahead of Gate 2
- Used to stimulate creative thinking and to explore art of the possible
- Attendees – look to invite creative thinkers who are not restricted or constrained by what is already there (wackier the better!)
- Look to generate new ideas, concepts and perceptions (alternatives and options) – how could we deliver the solution/service in a different way
- Prepared and able to look beyond what is already known/the norm – innovation
- You don't need to be an expert in the service area to participate
- No such thing as a bad idea!

Black Hats – Critical Review

The Black Hat

Is this true? Will it work?
What is wrong with it?
Caution
Judgement
Assessment
Logic
Evidence
Consequences
Weakness

TYPES OF BLACK HATS:
- **Interim**
- **Technical & Operational**
- **Mobilisation and Transition**
- **Commercial & Financial**

- Designed to expose solution and all key assumptions (both technical and commercial) to critical review.
- Mandatory - Not an approval process but must be able to evidence that bid solution have been subject to robust challenge prior to presenting bid for formal Gate sign-off approval!
- Attendees - Strong critical challengers who are not part of the Bid Team. Operational knowledge and expertise and the more diverse the challengers the stronger the outcomes. Include individuals from within the BU operations who would own contract if successful
- There is no rank or seniority in a Black Hat. Ideas and criticisms are discussed on their merit and not on the position or experience of the originator.
- No question is too simple or stupid. It is often the naive questions that can reveal a basic flaw in the thinking behind the solution or logic it follows.
- No limit to how many are held!

This is one of the most important meetings in the Serco Group. This is where you can win or lose a bid!

Red Team Review
Articulate the solution, maximise the scoring!

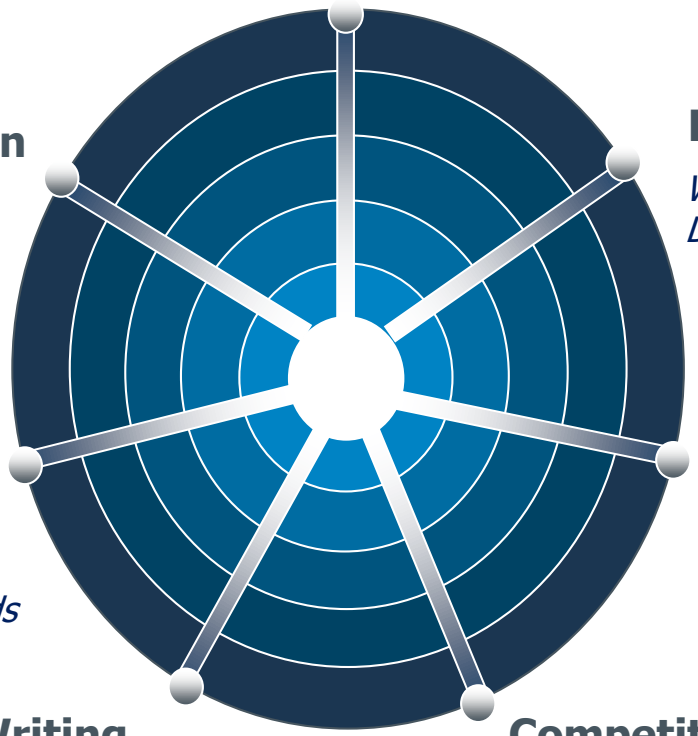
- The Red Team review the entire written bid response. They should identify gaps or weakness in the response and ensure that every question is fully answered – thereby ensuring compliance.
- Reviewers should provide critical analysis of the proposal to ensure that content is not missed or excluded and is compelling. Red Team will also check that the document itself is consistent and coherent.
- The Red Team must not be part of the Bid Team, and should include SMEs for any specialist or technical sections together with experienced bid writers and reviewers.
- Red Team reviews are not to be used to challenge the solution itself. However significant issues should be flagged to the Capture Lead and Solution Lead to investigate and take appropriate action prior to final formatting and printing.

Red Team review is intended to be wholly constructive rather than destructive and provide valuable feedback on written submission to enable Bid Team to improve our chances of success

Red Team Review – Things to Look for When Reviewing

Compliance

With customer's instructions
Use customers same language and phraseology



Page & Document Design

Is the document appealing?
Not too long

Responsiveness

What's driving the customer's requirement?
Do you understand the drivers?

Visualisation

High quality graphics/photos are essential.
Picture paints a thousand words

Strategic Focus

Why Serco?
Have we highlighted our differentiators?

Quality of Writing

Quick, easy reading
Easy to find information
Short sentences (max 20 words per sentence)

Competitive Focus

Often the weakest area
Highlights why the customer should not buy from the competition

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- Understanding the Stakeholder Landscape
- Role of Solution Hats and Red Team Reviews

Wrap-up and Closing Remarks

Wrap Up

- The Bidding and Transition Standards are the **source documents** for bidding and transition requirements.
- Whilst there are many supporting methodology approaches/requirements the Requirements are **NOT** a substitute for the Standards.
- All the checklists, templates, pro-forma etc. in the world are not going to win a bid. Good decision making, clarity of roles with individual responsibility and accountability and a common language and method all help.
- Is your view of your role on bids the same as at the beginning – if not, in what way is it different?
- Link takes you to the SMS bidding standards Https://my.serco.com/cms/wp-content/uploads/2019/04/SMS-GS-BD1_Bidding.pdf

Useful Resources

- The UK&E Bidding Knowledge Network provides bid related information, templates, case studies and links to other bid related sites.

  https://gbrserco.sharepoint.com/sites/UKEBiddingKnowledgeNetwork

- The Commercial Assurance and Lifecycle Review SharePoint site is an open-access site containing some useful information such as templates, guidance and the UK&E BLRT/IC Calendar (which can be synchronised with your own Outlook calendar)

  https://gbrserco.sharepoint.com/sites/CommercialAssuranceLifecycleReviewHub

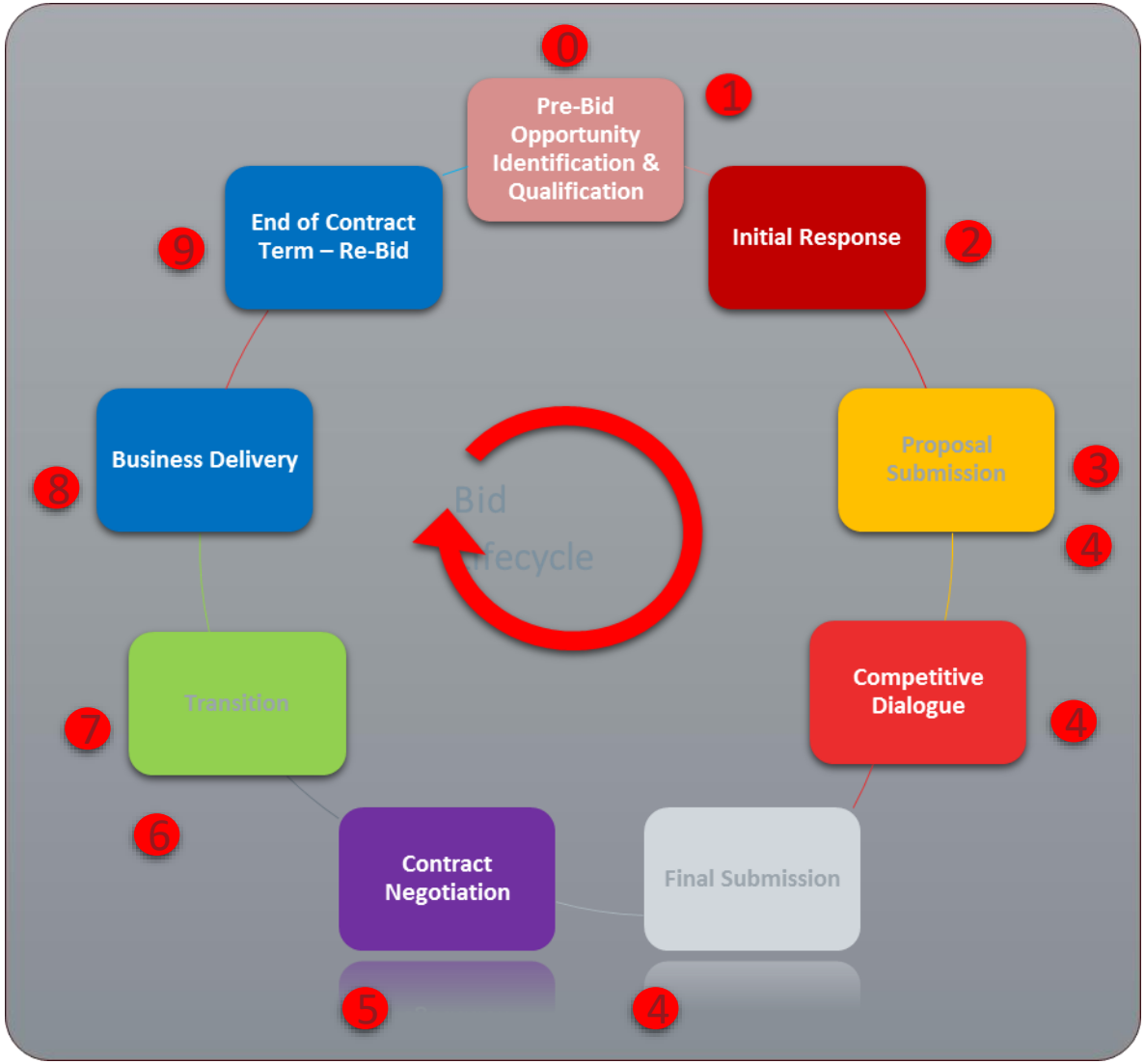
Re-visiting Learning Objectives

1. Gain an understanding of Serco's Business Lifecycle, bid processes and how the bidding cycle aligns to SMS Bidding Standard
2. Gain an understanding of the role of BLRT, Bidding Governance Gates 1-5 and the associated key mandatory activities and compliance requirements
3. Raise awareness of the bid methodology process, especially proposal development and submission and your role in this
4. Understand the role that solution Hats play in developing a compelling proposition
5. Understand the role and purpose of the Red Review in articulating our offer and maximising evaluation score

Final Thoughts

- Are there any 'takeaways' which people would like to share?
- Any final questions?
- Finally…..if you're interested in taking part in a Green Hat, Red Review or Black Hat please drop an email to Beth

The Bidding Lifecycle



Aligned to Governance Decision Points

Gate 0 – Internal qualification
Gate 1 – Go Get
Gate 2 – Bid/No Bid (PQQ Stage)
Gate 3 – Internal re-qualification (ITT Received)
Gate 4 – Approval to submit bid*
Gate 5 – Contract Signature
Gate 6 – Contract Start-up
Gate 7 – Transition Close
Gate 8 – Service Delivery/Transformation
Gate 9 – Rebid/Contract Close Down

* Gate 4 approval is required every time a detailed solution design or priced proposal is submitted to the client.